Welcome Document

Dartmouth Libraries

Concepts to Code: Building Good Computational Research Practices with R

Sept 2 & 3, 2026

Berry 180A (The LINK)

Baker-Berry Library, Dartmouth College

Before the Workshop Begins

Download R and RStudio following the instructions here.

What to bring

1. Laptop and charger (unless your battery can last all day)
2. *Optional*: a research project you are interested in starting (with data)
3. Come with an open mind ready to learn

Key Links / Resources

- Registration Page with workshop description. *Note: register for both days!*
- The Workshop Github repository
    - **Welcome Document (START HERE)**: dartgo.org/f26_research-fundamentals (QR code below)

- **DIRECT DOWNLOAD LINK** - *click here to download workshop materials*: dartgo.org/f26_research-fundamentals_download (QR code below)

Instructors

EMILY MYERS

Research Data Librarian, Research Facilitation (Dartmouth Libraries)

Specialties: quantitative social sciences, causal inference, data analysis in R, data visualization

Meet with me: dartgo.org/emily-cal

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KATIE OWERS BONNER

Senior Research Data Science Specialist, Research Facilitation (Dartmouth Libraries)

Specialties: quantitative analysis, biological and medical research, data visualization, programming in R

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JEREMY MIKECZ

Research Data Science Specialist, Research Facilitation (Dartmouth Libraries)

Specialties: bibliometrics, data visualization, digital humanities, GIS & digital mapping, programming in Python & R, text analysis / handwritten text recognition

Meet with me: dartgo.org/jeremy

Contact me: jeremy.m.mikecz@dartmouth.edu

Research Facilitation

You can contact your instructors directly at the email addresses listed above.

But do you have a computational research or data-intensive project you need help with, but not sure who to ask? Contact our department at Research.Facilitation@dartmouth.edu.

To learn more about our group visit our webpage.

Facilities: Dartmouth Libraries

The LINK (Berry 180A)

The LINK is found on Berry Floor 1 directly across from the circulation desk (to the east)

Accessible entrance

Handicap parking and an accessible entrance may be found on the East side of Baker (on College Ave., see the library Plan your visit page for more detail).

Restrooms

Restroom map

- **Men's and women's restrooms** are found just to the right of the circulation desk
- **All-gender, single-occupancy restrooms** - nearest locations:
  - In the stairwell behind the former Baker Café
  - In the Stacks, there are multiple near the elevator on the following floors (Basement + Floors 4, 5, and 6)

Schedule

This workshop pairs Concepts lessons with Coding lessons.

In the **Concepts lessons** ("a" sessions), you will learn computational research principles - ideas that apply regardless of tools used: from file-naming conventions and project organization to reproducibility and programming best practices.

In the **hands-on Coding lessons** ("b" sessions), you will apply and practice what you learned in the Concepts sessions: i.e., setting up a project in R Studio, and writing R code that explores, cleans, analyzes, and visualizes your data.

Day 1 (Wed. Sept 2)

- **9:00 - 9:15 Welcome / Introductions / Get to know the people around you**
- **Session 1a: Research Questions & Project Design (9:15 - 10:15am)**
- *Break*
- **Session 1b: Starting a Research Project in R (10:30 - 12:00)**
- *Lunch*
- **Session 2a: Exploring your Data (12:45 - 1:45pm)**
- *Break*
- **Session 2b: Exploratory Data Analysis in R (2:00 - 3:30pm)**

Day 2 (Thurs. Sept 3)

- **9:00 - 9:15 Welcome / Intros**
- **Session 3a: Introduction to Data Cleaning for Analysis and Reproducible Research (9:15 - 10:15am)**
- *Break*
- **Session 3b: Data Cleaning with R (10:30 - 12:00)**
- *Lunch*

- **Session 4a: Computational / Reproducible Research Best Practices (12:45 - 1:45pm)**
- *Break*
- **Session 4b: Applying Reproducible Research Best Practices to your Own Projects in R (2:00 - 3:30pm)**

Feedback

Our goal is to provide positive and meaningful educational experiences for all participants in our workshops. Help us improve by letting us know what we did right, what we can improve on, and what other workshops / offerings you would like to see in the future. **Please fill out this survey at the end of our workshop: dartgo.org/feedback.**